THE MASTERMIND COACHING CLASSES

CBSE / RBSE • NURSERY – CLASS XII • JAIPUR

Road No. 5, VKIA, Jaipur — 9887258679

CLASS 10 — ENGLISH · MEDIUM LEVEL CHAPTER TEST SET 2

Chapter 23: **The Ball Poem (First Flight Poem)** | RBSE Pattern | Session 2026–27

Time: 1 Hour 30 Minutes Name: _____ Roll No.: _____ **Maximum Marks: 40**

General Instructions:

1. All questions are compulsory.
2. Q. 1–10 are Objective Type (1 mark each).
3. Q. 11–14 are Very Short Answer Type (2 marks each).
4. Q. 15–18 are Short Answer Type (3 marks each).
5. Q. 19–20 are Long Answer Type (5 marks each).
6. Internal choice is given in Q. 17 to 20.
7. Write the question number before each answer.
8. Medium level: multi-step questions.

SECTION — A (Objective Type Questions) 10 × 1 = 10

Choose the correct option and write it in your answer book.

1. Which of these is a theme? 1

(a) friendship **(b)** adventure
(c) coming of age through loss **(d)** trade

2. 'Possessions' means: 1

(a) people **(b)** places **(c)** ideas **(d)** things one owns

3. 'He senses first responsibility' means: 1

(a) he realises that he must care for things **(b)** he learns to play
(c) he becomes a leader **(d)** he gets a job

4. The poem is a: 1

(a) comedy **(b)** epic **(c)** reflective lyric **(d)** ballad

5. Which is an example of a rhetorical question? 1

(a) What is he to do? **(b)** The boy cried.
(c) The sea is wide. **(d)** A ball fell.

6. The poet is wise because he: 1

(a) laughs **(b)** buys a ball
(c) does not trivialise the boy's pain **(d)** ignores the boy

7. The poet's use of rhetorical question 'What is the boy now?' is to: 1

(a) find a ball **(b)** ask a quiz
(c) joke **(d)** stress the boy's helplessness

8. The poem's irony lies in: 1

(a) a poet playing **(b)** a boy buying a ball
(c) a harbour closing **(d)** joyful bounce leading to grief

9. The poem reminds us that: 1

(a) money solves all **(b)** toys never break
(c) loss is a part of life **(d)** water is safe

10. The effect of repeating 'what, what' is to: 1

(a) create rhyme **(b)** add humour
(c) show the poet's concern and urgency **(d)** slow the pace

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer Type) — 4 × 2 = 8

Answer in about 20–30 words each.

11. How is the ball a symbol? 2

12. How does the poem avoid sentimentality? 2

13. Explain: 'money is external'. 2

14. What is the role of the setting? 2

SECTION — C (Short Answer Type) — 4 × 3 = 12

Answer in about 40–60 words each.

15. How does the poem present grief as a learning experience? 3

16. Explain how tone shifts from description to reflection. 3

17. Use 'console' and 'responsibility' in sentences. 3

OR

Comment on the use of the first person 'I' in the poem. 3

18. How does the poet generalise from a single boy to all humans? 3

OR

Give the noun form of 'grieve', 'lose' and 'possess'. 3

SECTION — D (Long Answer Type) — 2 × 5 = 10

Answer in about 100–150 words each.

19. Write a critical appreciation of the poem. 5

OR

Imagine you are the boy years later. Write a letter to the poet. 5

20. Compare the way loss is treated in 'The Ball Poem' and 'The Sermon at Benares'. 5

OR

Discuss the symbolism in the poem. 5

END OF QUESTION PAPER — Total: 40 Marks

MASTERMIND